



UNIVERSITY OF NAIROBI
DIRECTORATE OF UNIVERSITY ADVANCEMENT
AND INSTITUTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

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16th June 2026

Dear All

RE: APPOINTMENT TO THE INNOVATION ECOSYSTEM MAPPING RESEARCH TEAM

Greetings.

Following the revision of the budget allocation for the Innovation Ecosystem Mapping exercise it became necessary to establish a lean, multidisciplinary, and results-oriented team capable of delivering the assignment efficiently while ensuring prudent utilization of available resources.

The Directorate of University Advancement, through the Engineering and Science Complex (ESC) Project, is pleased to appoint you to the **Innovation Ecosystem Mapping Research Team** for the University of Nairobi.

The Research Team shall comprise the following members:

1. Dr. Martin Nanje – Team Lead
2. Ms. Lydia Zachary – Co-Lead
3. Dr. Olila Mbadi – Member
4. Mr. Charles Katua – Member
5. Ms. June Tum – Secretariat
6. Mr. Shadrack Mutavi – Secretariat

This appointment reflects the confidence placed in your expertise, professional experience, and commitment to advancing the University's innovation agenda. The team has been selected to provide the technical, research, stakeholder engagement, and administrative capacity required to successfully undertake this strategic assignment.

The team is mandated to undertake a comprehensive Innovation Ecosystem Mapping exercise aimed at identifying innovation actors, institutional capacities, innovation assets, strategic partnerships, support structures, existing linkages, gaps, opportunities, and areas for collaboration within and beyond the University of Nairobi.

Specifically, the team shall:

- i. Develop and implement an appropriate methodology and work plan for the Innovation Ecosystem Mapping exercise.

- ii. Undertake stakeholder consultations, interviews, surveys, field visits, and institutional engagements necessary for data collection and validation.
- iii. Identify and document innovation assets, research outputs, commercialization initiatives, incubation and acceleration programmes, innovation hubs, laboratories, partnerships, and support mechanisms across the University.
- iv. Engage key stakeholders from academia, industry, government, development partners, investors, civil society, and innovation support organizations.
- v. Analyze and synthesize data to generate evidence-based findings and strategic insights on the University's innovation ecosystem.
- vi. Prepare and submit a comprehensive Innovation Ecosystem Mapping Report outlining key findings, opportunities, challenges, recommendations, and an implementation framework.
- vii. Present the findings and recommendations to the ESC Project Leadership, University Management, and other relevant stakeholders.

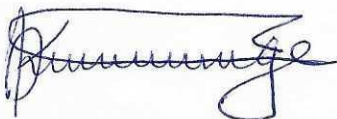
The assignment shall be undertaken in accordance with the approved Terms of Reference and project work plan. The team is expected to complete the exercise and submit all deliverables within the stipulated timelines.

All Faculties, Schools, Departments, Institutes, Centres, Directorates, and Administrative Units of the University are requested to accord the team the necessary cooperation, access to information, and logistical support required for the successful execution of this assignment.

The Directorate appreciates your willingness to serve and looks forward to your valuable contribution towards strengthening the University of Nairobi's innovation ecosystem and enhancing its position as a leading research, innovation, and entrepreneurial university.

Congratulations on your appointment.

Yours sincerely.



Prof. George Ooko Abong

ESC Project Manager

&

Ag. Director, University Advancement

Cc:

Vice Chancellor

Deputy Vice Chancellor (Research, Innovation and Enterprise)

Director, Research and Innovation